MatchLens

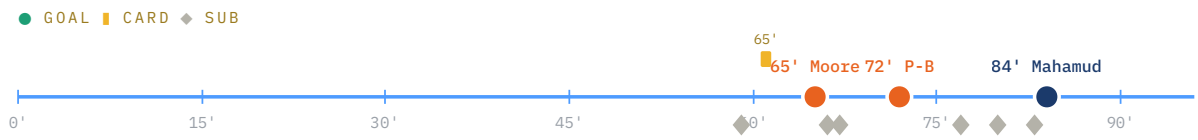
OPPOSITION REPORT

Hilltop

Combined Counties Prem North · scouted from Hilltop 1-2 Wokingham Town · 31 July 2026

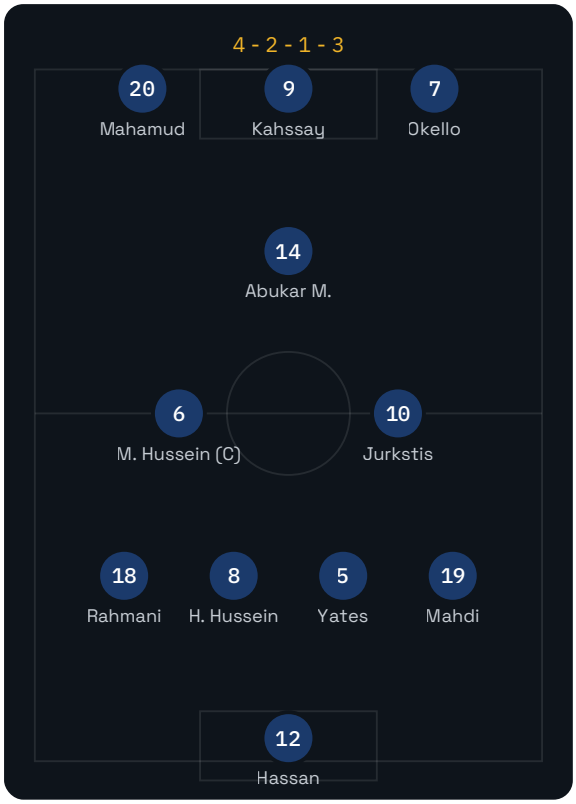
SHAPE	DANGER	WEAK POINT	THREAT SIDE
4-2-1-3	#20 Mahamud	Build-up	Their left

Match timeline



Line-ups

Hilltop



SUBS USED #11 Micheal Kikambi, #21 Ibrahim Benabbas, #3 Mohammed Amin, #2 Mohamed Afrah

Shot map



The short version

Hilltop play 4-2-1-3 and try to play out from the back every time. They are not good at it. Wokingham pressed that build-up properly once all night and scored from it. Everything else about beating Hilltop follows from that.

Their danger is almost entirely down their left: AbdulWahab Mahamud (#20, LW), with Sammim Rahmani (#18, LB) overlapping past him. Their captain Mohamed Hussein (#6, DM) is a big man who takes every set piece and shoots from distance. Stop those three and there isn't much else.

Five things to do:

1. **Press their goalkeeper and centre-backs.** They want to play short and will keep trying it. Squeeze it and they turn it over; sit off and they go long anyway.
2. **Put the ball in behind their back four.** There is no pace across it.
3. **Let their centre-backs come, then hit the space they leave.** Give them room and they will carry it forward. Mohamed Hussein (#6, DM) is slow to drop in and cover behind them.
4. **Get at Rinalds Jurkstis (#10, DM).** He gives it away under pressure and shows you where the pass is going.
5. **Work your corners short.** They defend the box, not the edge of it.

How they line up

A 4-2-1-3. Hossam Hassan (#12, GK) in goal. A back four of Sammim Rahmani (#18, LB), Hussein Hussein (#8, LCB), Jack Yates (#5, RCB) and Jibril Mahdi (#19, RB). Mohamed Hussein (#6, DM) and Rinalds Jurkstis (#10, DM) sit in front of them, with Abukar Mohamed (#14, AM) ahead of that pair. AbdulWahab Mahamud (#20, LW), Nadeer Kahssay (#9, CF) and Tyrese Okello (#7, RW) across the front.

When they build, the two centre-backs split wide, both full-backs push high, and Mohamed Hussein (#6, DM) drops in or steps up to make the extra man. It is a very committed shape — when they lose the ball there is a lot of grass behind those full-backs.

The centre-backs will also travel forward with the ball if you let them. Left unpressed they step out of the back four and carry it into midfield, and Mohamed Hussein (#6, DM) does not drop in behind them to cover — so the ball-side centre-back position empties and stays empty.

How to hurt them

Press the build-up. This is the main one. They play short from goal kicks and from the back into a flat, static picture — the players ahead of the ball don't move to show for it, so the man in possession has one obvious option and takes it. They got away with it for an hour against Wokingham purely because Wokingham didn't press. The one time Wokingham did — closing a player down after they'd worked it out of defence — they won it 25 yards from goal and scored inside seconds. Jurkstis (#10, DM) is the man to press: he gave it away several times, and his body shape tells you where the pass is going before he plays it. Hussein Hussein (#8, LCB) also takes heavy touches with nobody near him.

Whatever they intend, the ball ends up in the same two places. Short is the plan — from goal kicks, from the back, and from the keeper's hands — and if you allow it, that is what they do. But nobody in front of the ball moves to offer a second option, so the man in possession runs out of ideas and goes long anyway, usually into the half-space. And when it isn't short, it is straight and direct to Nadeer Kahssay (#9, CF). Same picture whether the keeper has it at his feet or in his hands.

That gives you the choice. Press it and you win it high in a dangerous area. Sit off, let them start short, and set your line and your second-ball structure for the long ball you already know is coming — half-space or centre-forward, there is no third option.

Kahssay (#9, CF) himself is manageable. He held it up twice and lost as many duels as he won, and that was against centre-backs he had a clear physical advantage over. A decent centre-back deals with him. Push your line up and squeeze what drops.

Play in behind. There is no recovery pace in the back four. Hussein Hussein (#8, LCB) is slight as well as slow. Their offside line was beatable several times in the game and they got away with it.

Use the space in front of and behind the centre-backs. Two separate problems that compound each other. Mohamed Hussein (#6, DM) steps up out of the screening position and is slow to drop back into it, so there is a repeated hole between their back four and their midfield. On top of that, if you don't engage them, the centre-backs carry the ball forward out of the line themselves — and nobody fills the space they leave. Show them the ball, let one step in, then play into the gap he came from. It also means the moment you win it, their back line is a man short and unbalanced.

Their left-back leaves his side open. Rahmani (#18, LB) gets forward a lot — he went beyond his own front line three separate times, and won their penalty doing it. That is a threat going forward, but it means the space behind him on their left is available every time he goes. Switch it quickly when he's high.

Second balls. Their clearances from the back get swiped rather than struck properly. Set up to win what drops around the edge of their box.

They don't talk. Wokingham got an overload on one side and nobody in the Hilltop back four called it — every instruction came from the touchline. If you can create a numbers-up situation quickly, they are slow to sort it.

What they'll hurt you with

AbdulWahab Mahamud (#20, LW) — their best player. Quick, tricky, and he creates his own shooting space. He cuts inside onto his right foot and shoots — his 24-yard effort was tipped over in the first ten minutes. He also goes outside and crosses. He got a second shot away at the near post after a long ball over the full-back, forced a good save, and scored the penalty. He needs a defender showing him one way and cover behind.

Sammim Rahmani (#18, LB) — overlapping. He runs beyond the front line, not just up to it. He won the penalty by taking a one-two and arriving in the box behind the defence. Track the runner from deep on that side.

Mohamed Hussein (#6, DM) — captain, around 6'4". Takes every set piece, left-footed. Shoots from 30 yards if you give him time to set himself, and did exactly that in the second half. He was booked and came off with ten minutes left — when he goes, they lose their set-piece taker and their organiser in one, and their threat drops noticeably.

Jibril Mahdi (#19, RB). Gets up and down that side all game.

Off the bench: Micheal Kikambi (#11, CF) came on as centre-forward and was immediately busy, getting shots away. Ibrahim Benabbas (#21, RW) went to the right and combined well — he played the one-two for the penalty and had their last chance of the game.

Set pieces

Theirs, attacking. Mohamed Hussein (#6, DM) takes them, left-footed. Their corner delivery drew nothing — the movement in the box was static and Hussein drifted to the near post without attacking the ball. They took a run of corners in the first half and never went short. Their free kick from the edge was struck low and on target and their keeper had to work. Once Hussein came off, they had nothing from dead balls.

Theirs, defending. This is where they conceded. They mark man for man with one spare, and they leave Mahamud (#20, LW) alone up the pitch as an out-ball — roughly 30 yards clear of everyone else. Walls were two or three men depending on the situation. Everyone else goes in the box.

Because they set up for a delivery, the edge of their box is unguarded. Wokingham's second goal came from exactly that: corner played short, the receiver turned past his man on the edge, lofted it in, and the follow-up went in after the keeper parried. Work a short routine that creates the shot or the delivery from outside the area and they have nobody there.

Player by player

#	Player	What to know
12	Hossam Hassan (GK)	Comes for crosses and gets a hand to them, but leaves his goal open behind him. Goes long to the 9 from every goal kick in the second half. Made three good saves.
18	Sammim Rahmani (LB)	Left-back who joins the attack constantly. Won their penalty. Space behind him.

#	Player	What to know
8	Hussein Hussein (LCB)	Left centre-back. Slight, no pace, takes heavy touches under no pressure. Steps forward with the ball if unopposed. Press him.
5	Jack Yates (RCB)	Right centre-back. The most composed of the back four — played a good long ball over the full-back to set up a chance. Will also carry it forward given room.
19	Jibril Mahdi (RB)	Right-back. Works up and down the line all game.
6	Mohamed Hussein (DM)	Captain, roughly 6'4". All set pieces, left foot. Shoots from range. Slow to drop back into the screening position, and slow to cover behind a centre-back who has gone forward.
10	Rinalds Jurkstis (DM)	The weak link in their build-up. Gives it away under pressure and telegraphs the pass.
14	Abukar Mohamed (AM)	Plays off the striker. Quick, runs beyond the ball, sometimes too far to get back.
20	AbdulWahab Mahamud (LW)	Their danger. Cuts in to shoot, or goes outside to cross. Penalty taker.
9	Nadeer Kahssay (CF)	Target man for the long goal kick. Receives with his back to goal and his first touch takes him backwards. Beatable in a duel.
7	Tyrese Okello (RW)	Right wing. Little to report — came off just after the hour.
11	Micheal Kikambi (CF)	Sub striker. Lively, shoots on sight.
21	Ibrahim Benabbas (RW)	Sub, right side. Good combination play.
3	Mohammed Amin (sub)	Late sub.

How the game went

Goalless at half-time and short of chances either way. Hilltop had the better of the ten minutes after the hour without scoring, then conceded twice in seven minutes — the first from the press on their build-up, the second from the short corner. They pulled one back from the penalty on 84 minutes and the last ten minutes opened up, with a clear chance at each end.

The game tells you they will keep playing their way regardless of what it is costing them, and that they respond with more urgency once they are behind than they show at 0-0.

Built from the coach's live touchline notes, the official match record and an independent report of the same fixture. Where the notes and the written accounts disagreed, the written accounts were followed.